CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 9

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- the benefits of massage
- the prices of services
- paying for appointments
- finding a family doctor

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- get a document from his doctor
- sign up for a health insurance plan
- ask for time off from his work
- reschedule his doctor appointment

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

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Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- 75 minutes
- 55 minutes
- 45 minutes
- 30 minutes

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- He wants to try relaxation therapy.
- He likes to play sports.
- He has a stressful job.
- He is upset about his appointment.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- impressed
- indifferent
- disappointed
- surprised

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- schedule regular appointments
- try a different massage therapist
- book his girlfriend an appointment
- take next Monday off from work

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- It will give him some time off from work.
- He doesn't have to work on Mondays.
- He doesn't want to have to wait long.
- It will relax him for the upcoming week.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a new activity available in the community
- ◯ a travelling circus that is coming to town
- ◯ things the woman did on her vacation
- ◯ places that have dog training courses

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Her dog was causing too much trouble.
- ◯ There wasn't much traffic on the roads.
- ◯ She wanted to get back before Saturday.
- ◯ There wasn't much to do at camp.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Her dog is used to taking long car rides.
- ◯ Her children attend a local circus school.
- ◯ She dislikes physical activity.
- ◯ She often loses when playing cards.

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ It's never too late to learn new skills.
- ◯ Games are a waste of time for adults.
- ◯ The woman's dog should be trained.
- ◯ The woman's interests are strange.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She will ask if another class time is available.
- ◯ She will sign up for one of the classes.
- ◯ She will cancel her usual Saturday plans.
- ◯ She will purchase an alarm clock.

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ how to do something somewhat new
- ◯ why one should learn a new skill
- ◯ how to skillfully compare dissimilar things
- ◯ why a particular endeavour is difficult

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ She lives close to several movie theatres.
- ◯ She has access to a television movie channel.
- ◯ Her friend invites her to watch movies at his house.
- ◯ Her friend has given her several movies to watch.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Never reveal the ending.
- ◯ Do so at the beginning of a review.
- ◯ Warn readers before doing so.
- ◯ Do so only for certain genres.

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She wrote book reviews in school.
- ◯ She used to be a teacher.
- ◯ She has an online movie blog.
- ◯ She used to be a singer.

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ movies produced in Hollywood
- ◯ movies of one particular genre
- ◯ movies produced in different countries
- ◯ movies full of special effects

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ relieved
- ◯ frustrated
- ◯ annoyed
- ◯ enthusiastic

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. The news report is mainly about _____
- ◯ creative ways for teaching children.
- ◯ new research on seniors' health.
- ◯ an innovative community program.
- ◯ an uncommon psychological treatment.

2. The seniors at the Toronto facilities likely _____
- ◯ play games with the children.
- ◯ organize activities for the children.
- ◯ supervise the children's playtime.
- ◯ make the children's lunches.

3. According to the news report, one benefit of the facility is a better _____
- ◯ range of activities for children.
- ◯ sense of respect toward elders.
- ◯ life expectancy for seniors.
- ◯ immune system for children.

4. Some people have worries about the _____
- ◯ type of activities.
- ◯ lack of research.
- ◯ kind of interaction.
- ◯ spread of germs.

5. In the report, this new type of centre is supported by _____
- ◯ parents of young children.
- ◯ childhood development experts.
- ◯ seniors' facility workers.
- ◯ families of the resident seniors.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What is the problem with the company's mail?
- ◯ It gets lost and misplaced in the system.
- ◯ Its handling costs are too high to sustain.
- ◯ It is often delivered to the wrong floor.
- ◯ Its expected arrival time is often delayed.

2. What does Collette, the woman who works in the mail room, think Deborah needs?
- ◯ a financial incentive
- ◯ a shared burden
- ◯ better organization
- ◯ updated technology

3. Will Collette hire someone?
- ◯ No, Human Resources refused for no reason.
- ◯ No, the firm will automate mail handling instead.
- ◯ Yes, if the personnel unit reverses its decision.
- ◯ Yes, just to process the packages and parcels.

4. Why is an automated mail cart not a good solution?
- ◯ They are not available yet.
- ◯ They are too expensive.
- ◯ They can get lost in big offices.
- ◯ They sometimes stop working.

5. What would be the problem with the partitioned box solution?
- ◯ Deborah would not agree to it.
- ◯ It would cost too much.
- ◯ It would have mixed results.
- ◯ Staff would find it complicated.

6. What does Bernard intend to suggest with his comment about the chair?
- ◯ His colleagues are clumsy.
- ◯ His colleagues are lazy.
- ◯ The chairs are old.
- ◯ The chairs are uncomfortable.

PART 5

7. What is conveyed by Bernard's comment about new software programs?

- ◯ optimism
- ◯ helplessness
- ◯ resignation
- ◯ surprise

8. What solution do they agree on?

- ◯ a solution for all mail
- ◯ a solution for external mail only
- ◯ a solution for internal mail only
- ◯ no solution at all

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. Traditional theories claim attention-seeking is a trait of _____

- ◯ first-born children.
- ◯ middle children.
- ◯ last-born children.
- ◯ only children.

2. Dr. William Trager would argue Timmy and Frank have _____

- ◯ different personality traits due to their birth order.
- ◯ characteristics that can be challenging for parents.
- ◯ different reliability ratings due to different IQ scores.
- ◯ personality traits that develop throughout childhood.

3. CEO Kirsten Grenville believes birth order personality theories are _____

- ◯ evolving.
- ◯ declining.
- ◯ profitable.
- ◯ scientific.

4. CEO Kirsten Grenville thinks people want books that _____

- ◯ explore theories of intelligence.
- ◯ foretell events using astrology.
- ◯ present proven scientific facts.
- ◯ validate their own intuitions.

5. Dr. Trager and CEO Grenville both suggest there _____

- ◯ needs to be more scientific research on this topic.
- ◯ is something people find appealing about this topic.
- ◯ are more parents gaining interest in this topic.
- ◯ are better books coming out about this topic.

6. The reporter thinks birth order personality theories have _____

- ◯ limited scientific foundations.
- ◯ never been scientifically investigated.
- ◯ never been explained by folklore.
- ◯ links with major marketing scams.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	paying for appointments
Question 2	get a document from his doctor
Question 3	
Question 4	45 minutes
Question 5	He likes to play sports.
Question 6	impressed
Question 7	schedule regular appointments
Question 8	It will relax him for the upcoming week.

PART 2	
Question 1	a new activity available in the community
Question 2	There wasn't much traffic on the roads.
Question 3	She often loses when playing cards.
Question 4	It's never too late to learn new skills.
Question 5	She will sign up for one of the classes.

PART 3	
Question 1	how to do something somewhat new
Question 2	She has access to a television movie channel.
Question 3	Warn readers before doing so.
Question 4	She wrote book reviews in school.
Question 5	movies produced in different countries
Question 6	enthusiastic

PART 4	
Question 1	an innovative community program.
Question 2	play games with the children.
Question 3	sense of respect toward elders.
Question 4	spread of germs.
Question 5	childhood development experts.

PART 5	
Question 1	Its expected arrival time is often delayed.
Question 2	a shared burden
Question 3	Yes, if the personnel unit reverses its decision.
Question 4	They sometimes stop working.
Question 5	It would have mixed results.
Question 6	His colleagues are lazy.
Question 7	optimism
Question 8	no solution at all

PART 6	
Question 1	last-born children.
Question 2	personality traits that develop throughout childhood.
Question 3	profitable.
Question 4	validate their own intuitions.
Question 5	is something people find appealing about this topic.
Question 6	limited scientific foundations.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You are about to hear a conversation between a man and a woman at a massage clinic. The woman works at the clinic and the man is asking for information.

Section 1:

MAN: Hi there. I was walking by and noticed your sign outside. It says that you do massage therapy here and you can bill my health insurance for part of it. Is that correct?

WOMAN: It certainly is. We do massage and acupuncture here. Would you like to book an appointment?

MAN: Yes, but first I want to make sure it's covered through my health insurance plan at work. I'll come back once I find out.

WOMAN: No problem. But just to let you know, in order to be covered for special therapies like massage or acupuncture, most health insurance companies require a referral note from a family physician.

MAN: Oh really? Ok, well I actually have an appointment with my family doctor tomorrow.

WOMAN: That's perfect! See you later then.

Now answer questions 1-2.

1. What is the man inquiring about?
2. What is the next step for the man?

Section 2:

MAN: Hi, I'm back, and I have a referral form from my doctor. I've had this terrible pain in my shoulder for weeks, probably from playing basketball or baseball.

WOMAN: Well, we have registered massage therapists that specialize in sports injuries. Would you prefer a full body massage or just to treat that one specific area?

MAN: I think I'd prefer to focus on my upper back. That's helped before. My arms, legs, and feet get a little achy after a game, but nothing too bothersome.

WOMAN: OK. We can book your massage for 30 minutes, 45 minutes, 60 minutes, or 75 minutes.

MAN: Hmm, what do you suggest? I'd love a 75-minute massage, but maybe that's too much time to spend on one area. Thirty minutes seems too short, though.

WOMAN: Well, since you're only treating one area, I'd probably recommend a 45-minute massage.

MAN: Oh, I almost forgot. My girlfriend wants to come too. Do you have two appointments at the same time? She wants a 60-minute relaxation massage.

WOMAN: OK then . . . you're in luck, it looks like we've had a cancellation and I can fit you both in Thursday, at five o'clock.

Now answer questions 3-5.

3. What area of his body is bothering the man?
4. How long will the man's appointment be?
5. What is likely true about the man?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: So, how was your massage? Does your shoulder feel better?

MAN: Yes, it really does! My therapist used just the right amount of pressure. Would it be possible to book monthly appointments with her?

WOMAN: Of course! I'm glad you're pleased. How about your girlfriend? Did she have a positive experience?

MAN: I'm not sure . . . she's not out yet.

WOMAN: OK then, so is there a day and time that would work best for you?

MAN: Monday evenings would be good, after 5:30 when I get off from work. It'd be a great way to start the week. Maybe the last Monday of each month.

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. How does the man feel about his massage?
7. What does the man want to do?
8. Why did the man want the time he chose?

PART 2

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation between two neighbours.

MAN: Tanya! You're back from camp! I thought you were gone until tomorrow? Did you get bored?

WOMAN: No, camp was great. But the roads back were clear, pretty much the whole way, so we made great time.

MAN: Well, it's good to see you. We missed you guys at card games night last Saturday.

WOMAN: Ha! You mean you missed having someone to beat! I'm still not convinced you don't cheat somehow . . . no one can win every time without a few tricks up their sleeve. Anyways, so what's new?

MAN: Not much—same old, same old. Oh! But on Tuesday, when I was volunteering at the community center, I saw something posted that might interest you.

WOMAN: Really? Were they advertising dog training classes by any chance? I don't know if it was just payback for taking him on his first long car ride, but Teddy was causing some serious trouble on our trip.

MAN: Well, they might have those too, although Teddy always seems to be on perfect behaviour when I'm around. But no, the poster I saw was about a new circus school that just opened a few blocks away . . . in that grey building next to the grocery store. I was thinking . . . you're always saying how much you wanted to be a circus performer growing up—now's your chance!

WOMAN: Are you serious? A circus school? I'd love that! I imagine it's just for kids, though. There probably aren't many adults out there still dreaming of being circus stars.

MAN: Actually, I checked it out, and the majority of classes are for adults. Apparently, you aren't that strange after all! Samantha even found a class that she thought looked fun . . . some sort of combination of yoga and acrobatics.

WOMAN: Ahh, acroyoga. I could see her liking that! Well, I'll definitely have to check it out. I hope they have classes in trapeze—that's what I've always wanted to try the most.

MAN: They have one on Saturday nights and bright and early Sunday mornings.

WOMAN: Yuck! I hate getting up early, especially on a Sunday! But I can't leave you without someone to beat at cards on Saturday night . . . so I guess I'll be setting my alarm clock!

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. What is this conversation mainly about?
2. Why did the woman get back to town early?
3. What is probably true about the woman in the conversation?
4. Which statement would the man likely agree with?
5. What was the woman's decision at the end of the conversation?

PART 3

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You are about to hear a conversation between two friends.

MAN: Hi Alice, how are you? Still watching a different movie every night?

WOMAN: Yes, Daniel, I am! I'm so glad you recommended that I subscribe to that international movie channel! It doesn't add that much to my television bill every month, and I'm really enjoying it! I'll never have to go out to a theatre to see a movie again!

MAN: Have you considered writing reviews? Maybe you could get them posted online, on a movie blog.

WOMAN: Oh, I'm not sure . . . I've never written a movie review before.

MAN: It's not that difficult. You had to write book reviews in school, didn't you? First, you should identify the genre: for example, is the movie a comedy or a romance or an action movie? Then you can talk about the plot: what happens.

WOMAN: But I don't want to spoil the movie for other people!

MAN: Exactly. So either don't tell them how it ends or tell them in advance that you're going to. It's called a "spoiler alert." You can also talk about the characters and the dialogue: are the people interesting; is their conversation realistic?

WOMAN: In book reviews, we also talked about theme and setting. I could do that for the movie as well.

MAN: Yes. And then, since a movie is NOT a book, you can talk about the acting, the costumes, the soundtrack, the special effects—

WOMAN: Soundtrack? Special effects?

MAN: The soundtrack is the music. Remember that Celine Dion song from that movie we watched together at my place—Titanic? And special effects—remember that Star Trek movie I gave you?

WOMAN: I LOVE that song! And the Star Trek movie was full of spaceships and alien creatures . . . Oh, I see what you mean. Any other advice?

MAN: Well, again, I encourage you to submit your reviews to a movie blog or something. I think that there's a great need for reviews about movies that are NOT your typical Hollywood productions that everybody sees and everybody knows about.

WOMAN: Okay, thanks! I can't wait to show you my first attempt!

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. What is the conversation mainly about?
2. Why is the woman watching a lot of movies?
3. What does the man say about revealing the ending of a movie in a review?
4. What is true of the woman?
5. What kind of movies does the woman tend to watch?
6. How does the woman feel about the man's overall suggestion?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about a local development.

A new daycare is set to open at Mayfair Seniors' Residence this month. The concept, although not new in Canada, is the first of its kind in Saskatchewan. In fact, the city of Toronto has been running combined facilities for over 25 years with tremendous success. The combined care centres are intended to foster intergenerational interaction among the children and seniors. Psychologist Lynda Rogers says there are benefits for both parties.

On the one hand, seniors are encouraged to socialize and get moving by participating in activities with the children, which are supervised and organized by licenced professionals. Other potential health benefits for seniors include lower levels of depression and slower cognitive decline. For the children, Rogers says it's an opportunity to develop empathy and understanding towards others. It may even help reduce age discrimination.

Some community members have expressed health concerns; however, manager of Toronto's early childhood education facilities, Mansour Jalali argues that their centres have not seen any significant increase in illnesses because careful sanitation measures are taken. Participants must use hand sanitizer before and after activities, and the centre has disinfectant protocols in place for the daycare and residential centres.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three people, two women and one man, in a company's mail room. They are talking about a problem in the company.

Andrea: Colette, we're not getting our mail fast enough. I got something today that was sent to me two days ago. From someone up on the third floor!

Bernard: That's ridiculous! I was just going to complain about external mail taking way too long to get onto our desks.

Colette: I know, I know! Deborah not only has to deliver the mail, she also has to sort it! There's so much of it, it often takes her all morning just to sort through it!

Bernard: I was going to ask if maybe we could come down and get stuff ourselves if it's particularly urgent. But I guess that wouldn't make a difference? . . .

Colette: I'm afraid not. Unless it's sorted already, you would have to look through several bins just to find it. I don't think I could let you do that. I've been trying to hire another person, but Human Resources says there's just not enough money.

Bernard: That's unfortunate. I guess one of those high-tech android mailbots is out of the question then.

Andrea: Those what?

Bernard: At my friend's office, they have one of these automated carts. It's like a little robot that goes from department to department all day long. When it shows up at your department, you take your incoming mail and put on your outgoing mail. It sounds so efficient.

Colette: Well, that would be less expensive than hiring another person. But I heard they can stall and if that happens somewhere in a hallway, it might take a while for someone to figure out what's happened and get it going again.

Andrea: What if we had a partitioned box at the elevator on each floor for internal mail. That way, we could pre-sort our outgoing mail by putting it in the right partition. Then all Deborah would have to do every hour or so is deliver it to us from those boxes.

Colette: Well, that would help the movement of the internal mail, but the movement of the external mail would be much slower. And besides, I would hate to add that to Deborah's duties.

Bernard: Well, if you're that anxious about external mail, why don't we get up out of our chairs and go and do it ourselves? I mean, we're not that old, guys! And anyways, they're developing new software every single day. Maybe soon we won't even need physical mail. I mean, in the future, just send a document and maybe everyone will just share it online!

Colette: Well, I think there will always be a need for some physical mail. Supplies, packages . . .

Andrea: So we're back where we started . . .

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about personality.

You've probably heard the theory: First-born children are reliable, middle children are sociable, last-borns crave the spotlight, and "onlies" are lonely. These notions—some would say stereotypes— arise from decades of research and form the backbone of hundreds of self-help and parenting books. The only problem? The notion that birth order affects personality is increasingly regarded by scientists as pure nonsense.

One such expert is Dr. William Trager of McGill University. He points to two recent international studies that turned up zero correlation between birth order and personality trait development. Trager says past studies that posited a link between birth order and personality were fatally flawed. One blunder, says Trager, was that researchers confounded their subjects' birth order with their chronological age at the time of the study. For example, suppose an eldest child, 16-year-old Frank, was subjectively described by family members as reliable compared to his youngest sibling, 10-year-old Timmy. Researchers concluded that Frank's reliability arose from the fact that he was first born. However, had the researchers come back 6 years later and repeated the questionnaire, Trager says they probably would have found that Timmy, by then 16 years old himself, would be rated as equally reliable, despite being the youngest. For Trager, continued belief in these theories is an indication of people's desires trumping their ability to reason.

Despite these findings, Kirsten Grenville, CEO of Global Publishing, says books on birth order theory have propelled a raft of popular psychologists and parenting experts to the top of the bestseller charts. For Grenville, the issue isn't whether or not birth order theory is scientifically valid. The issue, rather, is whether or not it sells product—and sell it does! Consumers' seemingly insatiable appetite for these books, says Grenville, stems from the fact that almost everyone has an instinctive sense that birth order theories are true, whether or not they really are. People read these descriptions of sibling relationship dynamics, and they think, "Yeah, that is true for me." Maybe the descriptions are like horoscopes: general enough that almost everyone can find something to agree with. Also, even if birth order doesn't scientifically correlate with personality trait development, there are certainly enough personal anecdotes, feelings, and hunches to suggest otherwise.

So can we finally put to rest this notion that birth order matters from a scientific perspective? Dr. Trager's response would be a qualified no. While personality may not be affected, birth order does appear to impact intelligence. Dr. Trager says studies have proven that compared to their siblings, first-borns are smarter on average by a full IQ point.